Achievement EHCP TARGET progression mapping

Counting Strand Overview

The counting strand focuses on developing pupils' understanding of number through structured and experiential counting processes. It begins with early engagement in counting through attention, anticipation and repetition, before progressing to recalling number sequences, counting objects accurately, and ultimately using counting flexibly as a tool for problem solving.

Why is it important?

Counting is the engine of number. It underpins addition and subtraction, number lines, and place value.

Without this - Number learning is fragile and easily breaks down

With it - Pupils can generate and manipulate numbers confidently

Pathway Aim

By the end of the pathway, pupils will be able to use counting accurately and flexibly to determine quantity, solve problems and apply number knowledge across a range of practical contexts.

Example Evidence Statements

"The pupil joins in with counting rhymes and anticipates the final number."
"They count objects accurately up to 5 using one-to-one correspondence."
"They can count forwards from a given number and backwards from 10 with increasing independence."

Experiential Counting **(Bands 1–2, emerging 3)** Pupils engage in counting as a shared experience through attention, anticipation and participation. They are not yet counting independently but are developing awareness of number through rhythm and repetition	**Rote Counting & Sequence** **(Bands 3–4)** Pupils recall number names in order and take part in structured counting routines. Counting may not yet be linked securely to objects.	**1:1 Correspondence** **(Bands 5–6)** Pupils count objects accurately by assigning one number word to each object and begin to apply this skill consistently.	**Flexible Counting** **(Bands 6–7)** Pupils count forwards and backwards and begin counting from different starting points, using counting flexibly in a range of contexts.

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Key stage Target By the end of the key stage, the pupil will engage in counting experiences through attention, anticipation and participation in rhythmic and repetitive number activities.	**Key stage Target** By the end of the key stage, the pupil will recall and use number sequences in order through verbal counting and structured routines.	**Key stage Target** By the end of the key stage, the pupil will count objects accurately using one-to-one correspondence, assigning one number word to each object.	**Key stage Target** By the end of the key stage, the pupil will count forwards and backwards and begin counting from a given number in a range of contexts.
Typical evidence might include: • attending to counting sequences • anticipating the next item/action • joining in with songs, rhymes or repeated patterns • tracking objects as they are counted	**Typical evidence might include:** • saying numbers in order (with or without support) • joining in with familiar counting routines • filling in missing numbers in a sequence • reciting number sequences during play	**Typical evidence might include:** • touching or moving each object when counting • counting objects accurately in small sets • stopping at the correct number • recounting to check	**Typical evidence might include:** • counting forwards from a given number • counting backwards • counting objects in different arrangements • recognising number patterns
Mapped curriculum targets **Band 1 -** • I can show anticipation when more objects are presented • I can attend to objects being moved or changed **Band 2 –** • I can show an awareness of number names through songs and rhymes • I can follow objects or sounds as they are counted or moved • I can anticipate when more items are added • I can link number words to objects	**Mapped curriculum targets** **Band 3 –** • I can say some number names **Band 4 –** • I can say numbers in order with support • I can begin to use a stable counting sequence • I can join in with counting songs consistently	**Mapped curriculum targets** **Band 5 –** • I can count up to 5 objects accurately • I can use one number for each object • I can count objects in different arrangements • I can stop counting at the correct number **Band 6 –** • I can count forwards to 10 • I can count out loud and keep track of objects	**Mapped curriculum targets** **Band 6 –** • I can count forwards to 10 • I can count backwards from 5 • I can recognise numerals to 10 • I can count out loud and keep track of objects **Band 7 –** • I can count forwards and backwards to 20 • I can count accurately in different arrangements • I can recognise patterns • I can start counting from a given number

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Band 3 (emerging) – • I can use counting-like behaviours such as pointing or making sounds • I can attempt to count objects with support • I can use number words like one or two when pointing to objects			
Next Step: begin recalling and joining number sequences	**Next Step:** apply counting to objects accurately	**Next Step:** use counting flexibly in different contexts and directions	**Next Step:** Use flexible counting strategies to support calculation, problem solving and understanding of number structure (e.g. counting on, counting back, number lines)